

XU XU

403 Robertson, Princeton, NJ 08544 | xx2728@princeton.edu | xu-xu.net | [Google Scholar](#)

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Assistant Professor of Politics and International Affairs, Princeton University 07/2021–
Post-doctoral Research Fellow, Stanford University 01/2020–06/2021

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science, Pennsylvania State University 08/2014–12/2019
M.A., Political Science, Columbia University 2013
Ph.D., Urban Engineering, University of Tokyo 2012
M.E., Urban Engineering, Tsinghua University 2009
B.A., Landscape Architecture, Wuhan University of Technology 2003

BOOK MANUSCRIPT

Xu, Xu. *Surveillance Authoritarianism: How Digital Technology Transforms Political Control in China.* Complete manuscript, under review.

PUBLICATIONS

13. Bo, Feng, Qiwei He, Xin Jin, and **Xu Xu***. 2026. “State Power Attracts Talent: Evidence from China’s Civil Servant Fever.” *Comparative Political Studies*. [*co-first author]
12. Pan, Jennifer and **Xu Xu***. 2026. “Political Censorship in Large Language Models Originating from China.” *PNAS Nexus*. [*co-first author]
11. Lu, Yingdan, Jennifer Pan, **Xu Xu***, and Yiqing Xu. 2025. “Decentralized Propaganda in the Era of Digital Media: The Massive Presence of the Chinese State on Douyin.” *American Journal of Political Science*. [*co-first author]
10. Pan, Jennifer, **Xu Xu***, and Yiqing Xu. 2025. “Disguised Repression: Targeting Opponents with Non-political Crimes to Undermine Dissent.” *Journal of Politics*. [*co-first author]
9. Chen, Ted Hsuan Yun, Christoper J. Fariss, Hwayong Shin, and **Xu Xu***. 2024. “Disaster Experience Mitigates the Partisan Divide on Climate Change: Evidence from Texas.” *Global Environmental Change*. [*co-first author]
8. **Xu, Xu**, Genia Kostka, and Xun Cao. 2022. “Information Control and Public Support for Social Credit Systems in China.” *Journal of Politics*.
7. Su, Zheng, **Xu Xu***, and Xun Cao. 2022. “What Explains Popular Support for Government Monitoring in China?” *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*. [*co-first author]
6. Cheng, Zhiyuan, Xin Jin and **Xu Xu***. 2021. “Is a Corruption Crackdown Really Good for the Economy: Firm-level Evidence from China.” *Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization*. [*co-first author]

5. **Xu, Xu**. 2021. “To Repress or To Co-opt? Authoritarian Control in the Age of Digital Surveillance.” *American Journal of Political Science*, 65.2: 309-325.
4. Frantz, Erica, Andrea Kendall-Taylor, Joseph Wright, and **Xu Xu**. 2020. “Personalization of Power and Repression in Dictatorships.” *Journal of Politics*, 82(1):372-377.
3. Cao, Xun, Genia Kostka, and **Xu Xu***. 2019. “Environmental Political Business Cycles: The Case of PM2.5 Air Pollution in Chinese Cities.” *Environmental Science and Policy*, 93: 92-100. [*co-first author]
2. **Xu, Xu**, and Xin Jin. 2018. “The Autocratic Roots of Social Distrust.” *Journal of Comparative Economics*, 46.1: 362-380.
1. Von Schrader, Sarah, **Xu, Xu**, and Susanne M. Bruyere. 2014. “Accommodation Requests: Who Is Asking for What?” *Rehabilitation Research, Policy, and Education* 28.4: 329-344.

WORKING PAPERS

6. **Xu, Xu**. “How Surveillance Legitimizes State Coercion in Times of Crisis.”
5. **Xu, Xu** and Lingyun Zhang. “Strategic Substitute or Complement? Protest Participation Under the Shadow of Repression.” [*co-first author]
4. Fan, Yingjie and **Xu Xu**. “State-Endorsed Moral Outrage: Crowdsourced Coercion in the Era of Social Media.” [*co-first author]
3. **Xu, Xu**. “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences.”
2. Jin, Xin and **Xu, Xu***. “Incentivizing Corruption: An Unintended Consequence of Bureaucratic Promotions in China.” [*co-first author]
1. Chen, Ted Hsuan Yun, Christopher J. Fariss, and **Xu Xu***. “Climate Disasters Mobilize the Rich and Suppress the Poor: Voter Turnout in Post-Harvey Texas.” [*co-first author]

WORK IN PROGRESS

4. Lu, Yingdan, Wenwei Peng, and **Xu Xu**. “Moral Propaganda and Social Order in Dictatorships”
3. **Xu, Xu** and Lingyun Zhang. “The Moral Foundations of Authoritarian Rule”
2. Haohan Chen, **Xu Xu**, and Wei Zhong. “The Rise and Contestation of Identity in Global Media.”
1. **Xu, Xu** and Wei Zhong. “AI Persuasion: LLM-Mediated Propaganda in China”

SELECTED TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Invited Speaker, Comparative Politics Annual Conference at Washington University in Saint Louis, April 2026.

Invited Speaker, China Research Workshop series at UC San Diego, March 2026.

Invited Speaker, “State-Endorsed Moral Outrage: Crowdsourced Coercion in the Era of Social Media.” Frontiers in Empirical Research on East Asia at NYU, January 2026.

Invited Speaker, “State-Endorsed Moral Outrage: Crowdsourced Coercion in the Era of Social Media.” Comparative Politics Seminar at Columbia University, February 2025.

Invited Speaker, “Decentralized Propaganda in the Era of Digital Media: The Massive Presence of the Chinese State on Douyin.” Comparative Politics Workshop at Yale University, December 2024.

Invited Speaker, “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences,” Spring/Summer 2024 Brown Bag Seminar Series at the Berlin Social Science Center (WZB), May 2024

Invited Speaker, “How Surveillance Justifies Mass Coercion: Insights from China’s COVID-19 Lockdowns,” Emerging Trend Talk series, Rutgers University, March 2024

Invited Speaker, “How Surveillance Justifies Mass Coercion: Insights from China’s COVID-19 Lockdowns,” Duke Law and Governance in Post-Pandemic workshop, Duke University, February 2024

Invited Speaker, “How Surveillance Justifies Mass Coercion: Insights from China’s COVID-19 Lockdowns,” Berlin Contemporary China Network Lecture Series on Digital Governance in China, jointly organized by researchers at the Humboldt University of Berlin, the Freie Universität Berlin, the Max Planck Institute for the History of Science, the Max Planck Institute for Social Anthropology, and the Technische Universität Berlin, December 2023

Invited Speaker, “How Surveillance Justifies Mass Coercion: Insights from China’s COVID-19 Lockdowns,” Stanford Center on China’s Economy and Institutions, Stanford University, November 2023

Invited Speaker, “Authoritarian Control in the Age of Digital Surveillance: the China ‘Miracle’,” Workshop on State Capacity Building in Contemporary China, Harvard-Yenching Institute, Harvard University, May 2023

Invited Speaker, “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences,” Comparative Politics Speaker Series, Harvard University, April 2023

Invited Speaker, “Disguised Repression: Targeting Opponents with Non-political Crimes to Undermine Dissent,” Chinese Politics and Economy Research Seminar Series, Initiative for U.S.-China Dialogue On Global Issues, Georgetown University, October 2022

Invited Speaker, “Morality and Repression: Targeting Opponents with Non-political Crimes to Undermine Dissent,” Distinguished Speaker Series, Department of Political Science at the University of Illinois at Chicago, October 2022

Invited Speaker, “Morality and Repression: Targeting Opponents with Non-political Crimes to Undermine Dissent,” Seminar on Law and Governance in China, Duke Law School, Duke University, October 2022

Invited Speaker, “State Building and Civil Servant Fever in Contemporary China,” Political Science Speaker Series, jointly organized by Duke University (NC), Columbia University (NY), University of Chicago (IL), and Peking University (Beijing), October 2022

Invited Speaker, “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences,” Political Economy Workshop jointly organized by CEIBS (Shanghai), NUS (Singapore), HKBU (Hong Kong), and NTU (Taiwan), May 2022

Invited Speaker, “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences,” “Speaking of China” Lectures, Rutgers Center for Chinese Studies, Rutgers University, April 2022

Invited Speaker, “The Unintrusive Nature of Digital Surveillance and Its Social Consequences,” Center for the Study of Contemporary China, The University of Pennsylvania, February 2022

Invited Speaker, “Information Control and Public Support for Social Credit Systems in China,” 21st Century China Center, School of Global Policy & Strategy, UCSD, February 2022

Invited Speaker, “The Social Costs of Digital vs. In-Person Surveillance,” Political Economy Workshop at the Higher School of Economics, Russia, March 2021

Invited Speaker, “Authoritarian Control in the Age of Digital Surveillance: The China Miracle?,” China Social Science Workshop, Walter H. Shorenstein Asia-Pacific Research Center, Stanford University, March 2021

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

- 2026 Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting, New Orleans, LA
- 2025 Chinese Politics Research in Progress Virtual Workshop. Organized by UC Berkeley & Harvard.
- 2025 APSA Annual Meeting, Vancouver, Canada
- 2024 APSA Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA
- Comparative Studies of Digital Repression Workshop, Hertie School, Berlin, Germany
- 2023 Mini-Conference on Chinese Politics at the APSA Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA
- 2022 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Montreal, Canada
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL
- UCSD China Survey Research Conference, San Diego, CA
- Getting China Right: Studying China in the (Post) Covid Era, Ann Arbor, MI
- 2021 China Social Science Workshop, Stanford University, Stanford, CA
- Seminar on Political Economy, Higher School of Economics, Moscow, Russia
- 2020 Mini-Conference on Chinese Politics at the APSA Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL
- Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA
- 2019 Mini-Conference on Chinese Politics at the APSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC
- Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting, Boston, MA
- Midwest International Economic Development Conference, Madison, WI
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL
- 2018 New Faces in China Studies Conference at Duke University, Durham, NC
- Quantitative China Studies Seminar at New York University, New York City, NY
- Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting, Provo, UT
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL
- Workshop in Applied and Theoretical Economics (WATE), Orlando, FL
- 2017 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA
- Southern Economics Association Meeting, Tampa, FL
- 2016 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA
- 2015 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA
- 2014 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Washington, DC

HONORS AND GRANTS

202 Center on Contemporary China (CCC) China and AI Research Award, \$35,000, Princeton University

2022 Funding from University Committee on Research in the Humanities and Social Sciences, \$10,000, Princeton University

2022 Funding from Data Driven Social Science Initiative, \$10,000, Princeton University

2020 Best Dissertation, Information Technology and Politics Section, American Political Science Association.

2019 Raymond E. Lombra and Roberta Lombra Outstanding Graduate Research Award, Penn State University.

2019 RGSO Dissertation Support, \$2000, College of the Liberal Arts, Penn State University.

2019 Program in Comparative Politics (PiCP) Graduate Research Award, \$2,000, Penn State University.

2018 Department of Political Science Summer Graduate Research Award, \$3,500, Penn State University.

2018 RGSO Dissertation Support, \$5000, College of the Liberal Arts, Penn State University.

2017 Program in Comparative Politics (PiCP) Graduate Research Award, \$4,500, Penn State University.

2017 Department of Political Science Summer Graduate Research Award, \$3,500, Penn State University.

2016 The Steighton (Steve) A. Watts, Jr. Endowed Graduate Scholarship in Political Science award, \$3,000, Penn State University.

2016 Department of Political Science Summer Graduate Research Award, \$3,500, Penn State University.

2016 Political Science Graduate Research Fellowship, Spring 2016, Penn State University.

2015 Program in Comparative Politics (PiCP) Graduate Research Award, \$2,000, Penn State University.

2015 Program in Comparative Politics (PiCP) Fellowship, 2015 Spring, Penn State University.

2010 Excellent Young Scholars Grant, \$2,000, one of 15 Students selected, Global Center of Excellence, Japan.

2009–2012 Tokyo University Scholarship for Excellent Doctoral Students, Japan.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Current Teaching – Princeton University

POL300: Conducting Independent Research in Political Science (Research Design) Fall 2024, 2025
– *Instructor*

POL434: The Political Economy of China, Past and Present Fall 2023, 2024, 2025
– *Instructor*

POL376 & SPI317: Dictators and Their Demise Spring 2022, 2023, 2024
– *Instructor*

SPI403: Digital Authoritarianism

Fall 2021, Spring 2024, Spring 2026

– *Instructor*Past Teaching – Penn State University

PLSC414: Dictators and Their Demise

Summer 2019

– *Instructor*

GLIS 102: Introduction to Global Studies

Fall 2019

– *Teaching Assistant*

– Giving guest lectures, Organizing group discussions, and other regular TA tasks

PLSC414: Dictators and Their Demise

Fall 2018

– *Guest Lecturer*

PLSC003: Introduction to Comparative Politics (150–250 Students)

Fall 2015, 2017, 2019

– *Teaching Assistant*

– Giving guest lectures, organizing group discussions, and other regular TA tasks

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Employment and Disability Institute, Cornell University

– *Research Assistant*

2013–2014

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Chair of the Information Technology and Politics Best Dissertation Award Committee, American Political Science Association, 2021

Faculty advisor, Schwarzman Scholarship Program, Princeton University, 2023, 2024, 2025.

Panel Chair at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2019, 2026), the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conferences (2022), and UCSD China Survey Research Conference.

Discussant at the American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2020, 2024, 2025), the Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conferences (2018, 2019, 2022), the Southern Political Science Association Annual Meeting (2026), the Virtual Workshop on Authoritarian Regimes (2020, 2022, 2024), Comparative Studies of Digital Repression Workshop at Hertie School (2024), and Quantitative China Studies Seminar at New York University (2022).

Reviewer for *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *American Journal of Political Science*, *American Political Science Review*, *Asian Journal of Social Science*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *China Journal*, *China Quarterly*, *Comparative Politics*, *Comparative Politics Studies*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *Crime, Law and Social Change*, *Energy Efficiency*, *Europe-Asia Studies*, *European Political Science Review*, *Government and Opposition*, *Industrial and Labor Relations Review*, *Information, Communication & Society*, *International Journal of Press/Politics*, *International Organizations*, *Journal of Chinese Political Science*, *Journal of Comparative Politics*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of East Asian Studies*, *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of Information Technology & Politics*, *Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *Journal of Politics*, *Perspectives on Politics*, *Political Behavior*, *Political Communication*, *Political Psychology*, *Political Science Research and Methods*, *Political Studies*, *Problems of Post-Communism*, *Public*

Opinion Quarterly, Scientific Reports, Science, Technology, and Human Values, Sociological Forum, and World Politics.

Judge for the undergraduate research poster session at the 2018 Undergraduate Exhibition at the Pennsylvania State University.

SKILLS

Languages: Chinese (Native Speaker), English (Fluent), Japanese (Intermediate).

Statistical Software: Python, R, STATA, GIS, SAS.